

BTN High - Answer Key

Gen Z Gender Roles

Episode 15 - 25 March 2026

Part 1: Traditional Gender Roles

Outline Gap Answers

- I.A.1: Women shown as **the homemaker**
- I.A.2: Men shown as **the breadwinner**
- I.B.1: Gen Z holds the **strongest** traditional beliefs
- I.B.2: **31%** of Gen Z men believe a wife should obey her husband
- I.B.3: **33%** of Gen Z men say a husband should have the final word
- I.C.1: **61%** of Gen Z men say enough has been done for gender equality
- I.C.2: **57%** of Gen Z men feel men are now discriminated against

Comprehension Question Answers

1. The Kings College study found that Gen Z holds the **strongest traditional beliefs** of all generations when it comes to gender roles. 31% of Gen Z men and 18% of Gen Z women believe a wife should always obey her husband.
2. **33%** of Gen Z men think a husband should have the final word on important decisions in the home.
3. Gen Z women hold these views at significantly lower rates than Gen Z men. For example, only 18% of women (vs 31% of men) believe a wife should obey her husband, and 19% of women (vs 33% of men) say a husband should have the final word. Similarly, 51% of women (vs 61% of men) say enough has been done for equality.

Part 2: The Role of Social Media

Outline Gap Answers

II.A: Josh Glover - facilitator at **Man Cave**

II.A.1: His organisation tackles **gender stereotypes** in schools

II.A.2: Social media helps bring back **outdated** gender norms

II.B.1: Algorithms create **echo chambers** where users hear agreeing voices

II.B.2: No one presents **alternative** opinions

II.B.3: Users only see opinions that get debunked or **smashed**

II.C.1: Teenage boys' definition of **feminism** differs from the intended meaning

II.C.2: This results from algorithms and lack of **conversation/time in conversation** with people who hold different views

Comprehension Question Answers

1. Man Cave is an organisation that tackles issues like gender stereotypes in schools. Josh Glover is a facilitator there. He says social media, particularly "manosphere" content, is helping to bring back outdated gender norms by creating echo chambers.
2. Social media algorithms create echo chambers where users only hear voices that agree with them. No one presents alternative opinions, and the only opposing views users see are the ones their preferred influencers "debunk" or "smash." This reinforces traditional beliefs without challenge.
3. Josh says teenage boys' definition of feminism is **very different** from the intended definition. He says they are "almost two completely different things." This disconnect results from algorithms and a lack of time spent in genuine conversation with people who hold different views.

Part 3: Tradwives and Solutions

Outline Gap Answers

- III.A.1: Tradwife influencers glamorise **traditional domestic** lifestyles
- III.A.2: Create content about cooking, cleaning, and **traditional/domestic** roles
- III.B.2: Support for violence to resist feminism was highest among **adolescent boys**
- III.B.3: Around **40%** of boys aged 13-17 agree women lie about domestic and sexual violence
- III.C.1: Two parts needed: **awareness** and problem-solving
- III.C.2: Need for **safe** conversations where people are not judged
- III.C.3: Importance of **role modelling** - older generations investing in younger people

Comprehension Question Answers

1. "Tradwife" (traditional wife) influencers are popular content creators who glamorise traditional domestic lifestyles. They create content about cooking, cleaning, and caring for a man, often framing these as natural roles for women. Josh argues they don't actually care about the best expression of being a woman - they care about making money.
2. The University of Melbourne study found that support for the use of violence to resist feminism was highest among **adolescent boys**, followed closely by adolescent girls. Around **40%** of boys aged 13-17 agreed that women lie about domestic and sexual violence, partly due to social media exposure.
3. Josh says the two parts to solving the problem are (1) **awareness** and (2) **problem-solving together**. Safe conversations are important because people need to be able to talk through ideas without being judged or shamed. He also emphasises **role modelling** - older generations investing time in younger people to provide guidance and alternative perspectives.

Part 4: Discussion - Model Answers

Think-Pair-Share Question 1 (Controlled - with scaffolding)

To what extent do you agree that Gen Z holds the strongest traditional beliefs about gender roles? Use at least two pieces of evidence from the video.

Model answer using the suggested structure:

I **partly agree** that Gen Z holds the strongest traditional beliefs. **The video showed that** 31% of Gen Z men believe a wife should obey her husband and 33% say a husband should have the final word. **Another finding was that** 61% of Gen Z men feel enough has already been done for gender equality. **Overall, this suggests that** while a significant minority of Gen Z hold traditional views, the majority do not - and many young people in the video expressed surprise at the findings.

Alternative position:

I **disagree** that Gen Z as a whole holds the strongest traditional beliefs. While the Kings College study found Gen Z scored highest statistically, **the video also showed** young people actively challenging these ideas and expressing disappointment. **Another finding was that** Josh Glover's perspective suggests the problem is driven by algorithm echo chambers rather than a genuine generational shift in values. **Overall, this suggests that** Gen Z may simply be more exposed to these debates, not necessarily more traditional at heart.

Think-Pair-Share Question 2 (Free practice - no scaffolding)

How can young people critically evaluate the social media content they see about gender roles?

Model response:

Young people can start by asking who created the content and what their motive might be - many influencers, as Josh points out, "care about making money" rather than presenting truth. They should look for evidence rather than emotional language, and ask whether different perspectives are being fairly represented. Following a range of viewpoints across the political spectrum helps break out of algorithm-driven echo chambers. Most importantly, they should discuss what they see with people who hold different views, because as the video shows, the lack of genuine conversation is what allows extreme ideas to go unchallenged. Role models - older siblings, parents, teachers - can help by creating safe spaces for these conversations without judgment.

Transcript

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qkX5CPXzjxs>

LEAVE IT TO BEAVER, 1957 OLD MOVIE: Starring Barbara Billingsley.

JOE BARONIO, BTN REPORTER: If you watch TV shows from the 1950s, you get a fairly black-and-white picture of the roles men and women should play in a family.

1950s TV SHOW: Well, whenever we cook inside, Mom always seems to cook it, but whenever we cook outside, you always do it. How come? Well, sort of traditional, I guess. You know, they say a woman's place is in the home, and I suppose as long as she's in the home, she might as well be in the kitchen.

This is what some people call "traditional" gender roles, with a woman as the homemaker and the man as the breadwinner. But it's something that society has long since left behind, right?

PERSON: I feel like we've got much more diversity now in like, in Gen Z. I just think it wouldn't really work in our society anymore yeah.

PERSON: I think generations like boomers then maybe more likely to have more gender roles embedded in their like lifestyle, I guess.

PERSON: Personally, I think like older generations, like maybe boomers, because that's what they grew around.

PERSON: But I also think it's passed down to our parents, so like millennials.

PERSON: Yeah kind of like what they're saying, like boomers, because I feel like now we like to challenge stereotypes and just go against gender roles.

Well, it turns out that it's actually Gen Z that is most likely to want a family that looks like this. The Kings College Global Institute for Women's Leadership has released a study of more than 23-thousand people from 29 countries, including Australia.

It found that of all generations from Baby Boomers to Gen Z, it's Gen Z that holds the strongest traditional beliefs when it comes to gender roles, with 31 per cent men and 18 per cent of women believing that a wife should always obey her husband. And 33 per cent of men and 19 per cent of women saying a husband should have the final word on important decisions in the home.

These attitudes towards women extend beyond just home life. The study also asked about things like equality in society. 61 per cent of Gen Z men and 51 per cent of Gen Z women say they feel enough has already been done for gender equality, with 57 per cent of men and 38 per cent of women saying they feel men are now discriminated against.

JOSH GLOVER, MAN CAVE: It's not surprising. It's sad, but it's not surprising.

This is Josh. He's a facilitator at Man Cave, which is an organisation tackling issues like gender stereotypes in schools. He says social media, particularly things like manosphere content which we've seen in the spotlight a bit recently...

...is helping to bring back what were once seen as outdated gender norms.

JOSH GLOVER: A lot of those men, a lot of those influencers hold traditional gender roles.

JOSH GLOVER: The whole narrative of echo chambers and what algorithms do and send us into this little shoot where we're just hearing all these people who agree with each other

JOSH GLOVER: But there's no one there to sort of present another opinion or the only alternative opinions you see are the ones where, you know, the person you agree with then like debunks or smashes or slams them in a debate or whatever it is.

JOSH GLOVER: I just fundamentally think that a teenage boy's definition of feminism is very different to the intended definition of feminism like that's, that's just so clear. So, we're actually talking about almost two completely different things and that, I would say, is a result of a lack of ability for these two definitions to have conversations with each other. And that just happens from, from the way the algorithms work, and the lack of time that we're spending actually in conversation with, with others who may hold different views, basically.

There are a lot of popular influencers who identify as "Tradwives", or traditional wives, and create content that's all about glamorising traditional domestic lifestyles.

JOSH GLOVER: The whole thing, the whole narrative of 'oh this is what women want I guess', women want to be in this 'tradwife' role which feminism is about choice and one of those choices is a traditional role and great. I wonder how much, again, kind of exactly the same thing that's happening with the manosphere influencers, it's like these 'tradwife' influencers, they don't actually care about what the best expression of

being a woman is. They care about making money, and so whatever it is that's going to get them more money, that's the one they're going to present.

The effects that gendered content have on young people can be extreme. A recent study from the University of Melbourne surveyed more than 2,300 adults and 1,100 young people aged 13 to 17, and found that support for the use of violence to resist feminism was highest among adolescent boys, followed closely by adolescent girls, and that around 40 per cent of boys aged 13 to 17 agreed that women lie about domestic and sexual violence, partly from social media exposure.

JOSH GLOVER: I think, you know, two parts of solving a problem. First one is awareness, and then second part is the actual problem-solving bit together. You know we talk a lot at the Man Cave about the importance of village. We just need to be able to have conversations, be, and, and safe conversations. And a safe conversation is with someone where I can trust that I can talk this idea out and not experience being judged or not experienced being shamed. If you are an 18-year-old, 19-year-old, who's the younger people in your world who you can start investing into? You know, if you're a 25-year-old, who's the 18-year-old? If you're a 50-year-old, who's the 30-year-old? Like just that, that role modelling that we've really, really missed now.